PROJECT 2: Multi-Page News/Magazine Site

Project Type: Individual Project **Points:** 25 points	**Due Date:** Monday, April 13, 2026 **Submit:** ZIP file (HTML, CSS, images, docs, design-process)

Project Overview

Design and build a 4-to-5-page website for a real or fictional news publication or magazine. This project emphasizes advanced layout skills, consistent navigation systems, content hierarchy, and professional web development practices. You will complete the full design process from initial concept through final implementation with emphasis on thoughtful planning through hand sketches and clean, well-structured code.

This project demonstrates your ability to create a cohesive, multi-page website with advanced layouts, typography systems, and performance optimization.

Learning Objectives

- Design and implement a multi-page website with consistent navigation
- Document your design process through hand sketches showing layout planning
- Master advanced CSS Grid and Flexbox layouts
- Build a reusable article template with sophisticated typography
- Implement SEO best practices and performance optimization
- Create media-rich pages with image galleries

Project Requirements

1. Publication Concept

Choose ONE type of news or magazine publication:

- Tech news and reviews (like The Verge, TechCrunch)
- Lifestyle or culture magazine (like Kinfolk, Monocle)
- Sports journalism site (like The Athletic, Bleacher Report)
- Food and travel magazine (like Bon Appetit, Afar)
- Business and finance publication (like Bloomberg, Fast Company)
- Arts and design magazine (like Dezeen, Design Milk)
- Your own creative concept (get approval first)

2. Design Process Documentation (Required)

Hand Sketches (Required)

- Create hand-drawn sketches showing your overall site layout for each page
- Sketch navigation, major content areas, and page structure
- Show how pages relate to each other
- Take clear photos of your sketches and place them in `assets/design-process/sketches/`

3. Required Pages (4 to 5 pages)

Page 1: Homepage (Required)

- Featured stories or hero section
- Grid of recent articles with thumbnails
- Navigation to all site pages
- Footer with site information (Description, Links, Social Media Links, and Copyright)

Page 2: Article Page (Required)

- Full article with headline, byline, date
- Hero image or featured image
- Body text with proper typography (minimum 500 words)
- Pull quotes or callouts
- Related articles sidebar or section

Page 3: Category or Section Page (Required)

- Grid or list of articles in a specific category
- Category header with description
- Consistent article card design

Page 4: About or Team Page (Required)

- Publication mission or story
- Team member profiles with photos
- Contact information

Page 5: Gallery or Media-Rich Page (Choose ONE)

- Photo gallery with grid layout
- Video showcase page
- Interactive infographic page

4. Technical Requirements

HTML Requirements:

- Semantic HTML5 throughout all pages
- Consistent navigation across all pages
- Proper heading hierarchy on every page
- Clean, well-formatted code with comments

- Valid HTML with no errors

CSS Requirements:

- External CSS file with organized structure
- Use both CSS Grid AND Flexbox for layouts
- Create a typography system with consistent sizes and spacing
- Implement CSS custom properties (variables) for colors, fonts, font-sizes, spacing, padding, border radius, shadows, and more
- Cohesive design system across all pages
- CSS animations for interactive elements (Mirco animations and keyframes animations)

Responsive Design:

- Desktop-first approach (design for desktop, then scale down)
- Two breakpoints: Tablet (768px) and Mobile (480px)
- All pages should be functional and readable at all sizes
- Navigation should adapt on smaller screens (Hamburger menu)
- Images and media should scale properly and not overflow their containers

SEO Optimization:

- Unique, descriptive title tags for each page (50 to 60 characters)
- Meta descriptions for each page (150 to 160 characters)
- Descriptive alt text for all images
- Semantic HTML structure
- Clean, descriptive URLs (e.g., /about.html, /articles/tech-trends.html)

Performance Optimization:

- Optimized images (compressed, proper dimensions)
- Lazy loading for images below the fold
- Fast loading times (under 3 seconds)
- Test with Lighthouse and aim for 85+ performance score

File Requirements

What to Submit:

```
LastName_Project2/
    index.html (homepage)
    article.html (article page)
    category.html (category page)
    about.html (about page)
    gallery.html (gallery or media page)
    assets/
        css/
            style.css
        images/ (all images)
        videos/ (all images - OPTIONAL)
```

```
        audio/   (all images - OPTIONAL)
        design-process/
            sketches/
    README.txt
```

File Naming:

`LastName_Project2.zip`
Example: `Kraishan_Project2.zip`

README.txt Requirements

Include a comprehensive README.txt file with:

- Your name and student ID
- Project title and publication concept (paragraph)
- List of all pages with descriptions
- Brief description of your sketching/planning process
- Fonts used with sources
- Color palette with hex codes
- Image sources and credits
- Special features or techniques used
- Any challenges and how you solved them

Grading Rubric (25 points total)

Criteria	Points	What I'm Looking For
Design Process & Sketches	**3**	1 sketch for each page. Clear, thoughtful hand sketches showing layout planning for your pages. Sketches demonstrate planning of navigation, content areas, and page hierarchy.
Multi-Page Structure & Navigation	**5**	4-5 pages with consistent navigation. All links work correctly. Clear site structure. Semantic HTML throughout.
CSS Grid & Flexbox Layouts	**5**	Effective use of both Grid and Flexbox. Advanced layouts. Clean, organized CSS. CSS custom properties for consistency.
Typography System & Article Template	**3**	Professional typography system. Well-designed article template. Excellent readability. Clear hierarchy. Pull quotes and formatting.
Responsive Design	**3**	All pages fully responsive. Works flawlessly on mobile, tablet, desktop. Navigation adapts appropriately. Content readable at all sizes.

Accessibility	**2**	Descriptive alt text on all images. Sufficient color contrast between text and background. Semantic HTML used correctly throughout. ARIA attributes added where needed. Visible :focus styles for keyboard navigation.
SEO & Performance	**2**	Proper meta tags on all pages. Optimized images. Fast loading. Good Lighthouse scores. Clean URLs.
Professionalism & Polish	**2**	Portfolio-quality work. Cohesive design. Professional content. Complete documentation. No errors or broken elements.

Design Guidelines

Creating Effective Sketches

Creating Effective Sketches

- Use simple boxes and lines to represent layout regions (header, nav, main, section, article, sidebar, footer)
- Label each section (e.g., "hero image", "article grid", "nav bar")
- Include rough placement of images, headings, and buttons
- You don't need to draw details - just show structure and hierarchy

Building Typography Systems

Article Page Typography:

- Headline: 36px to 48px (desktop), 28px to 32px (mobile)
- Subheadline: 20px to 24px
- Body text: 16px to 18px (larger for readability)
- Line height: 1.6 to 1.8 for body text
- Line length: 60 to 75 characters per line
- Pull quotes: 24px to 32px, styled distinctly

Performance Optimization Tips

Image Optimization:

- Hero images: 1920px wide maximum
- Article images: 1200px wide maximum
- Thumbnails: 400px to 600px wide
- Compress all images (TinyPNG, Squoosh)
- Use WebP format when possible

Tips for Success

Planning:

- Spend time sketching your layout before writing any code; it saves significant development time
- Study real news and magazine sites for inspiration
- Plan your content hierarchy before coding

Development:

- Create a consistent header and footer first
- Build one page fully before duplicating structure
- Use CSS variables for colors, fonts, and spacing
- Test navigation and links frequently

Quality Assurance:

- Test every page on mobile, tablet, and desktop
- Run Lighthouse on all pages
- Validate HTML for all pages using HTML Validator
- Validate CSS (style.css) using CSS Validator
- Check all links and images work correctly

Helpful Resources

Inspiration:

- The Verge (theverge.com) - Tech news design
- Medium (medium.com) - Clean article layouts
- The New York Times (nytimes.com) - Professional editorial
- Sport Illustrated (si.com) – Sports News
- Dribbble (dribbble.com) – Website Design Inspiration
- Behance (behance.net) – Website Design Inspiration
- Landbook (land-book.com) – Website Design Inspiration

Tools:

- TinyPNG/Squoosh - Image compression (https://squoosh.app/)
- Google Lighthouse - Performance testing (Google Chrome > Inspect > Lighthouse)
- W3C Validator - CSS validation (https://jigsaw.w3.org/css-validator/)
- W3C Validator - HTML validation (https://validator.w3.org/)

Need Help?

Office Hours: Tuesday & Thursday 2:00 PM to 3:30 PM
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